

Build and Use a Planning Canvas

Session 23 | Product and Delivery Teams | Intermediate

Use visible state when chat stops being enough

A canvas helps when work has several records, repeated updates, named actions, and a review view that must survive the conversation.

Start from the GitHub issue plan

The canvas should show:

- parent objective;
- issue and planning status;
- owner or ownership gap;
- dependency and risk;
- decision and next action.

Create it in plain language

```
/create-canvas Create a delivery-planning canvas for the approved GitHub issues.  
People can update planning status and record decisions. Copilot can summarize  
and propose updates. Do not close issues, change assignees, or publish content.
```

Review before use

Ask:

1. Does each field support a real decision?
2. Can every action be explained?
3. Are external writes excluded?
4. Can the owner recover?
5. When should the canvas be retired?

Simpler is better

Remove generated fields and actions that do not help the team decide or act.

A crowded canvas is not a mature canvas.

Load live GitHub issues

Use GitHub MCP to retrieve the Session 22 issues.

Copilot can move the approved fields into the canvas. GitHub remains the source for issue state.

Keep planning state explicit

The canvas may show `ready for review` while the GitHub issue remains open.

That is acceptable when the canvas labels the planning state and source-system state separately.

Verify three views

Compare:

- the visible canvas;
- Copilot's report;
- a fresh GitHub MCP read.

Resolve or explain every mismatch.

Lab result

- Learner-created canvas
- Reviewed state and actions
- Live GitHub issue data
- Human and Copilot updates
- Owner, recovery, and retirement

Stop if live canvas creation is unavailable.